



I could not push myself how I wanted to. The leg work on the runway was not the best. To make up for that, I tried to put more effort into the throw but could not get it right. I had a positive mindset at that particular point in time, so I got a good throw. Then again, the physical aspect pulled me back," Neeraj said after his Paris Olympics silver.

Terseus Liebenberg, a javelin throw coach and biomechanics expert based in Potchefstroom, South Africa, explained how a groin injury hampers the mechanics of javelin throwing.

"It's quite common for javelin throwers to sustain groin injuries. There's tremendous force placed on the body. It happens in two phases — on the penultimate stride when you are entering the final phase of the run-up, and during the throw. The lower body then moves the upper body, and you get a tremendous stretch on the groin," Liebenberg said.

Neeraj himself admitted that a weak left leg results in his body collapsing to the left side, thereby affecting the trajectory or line of the throw. "My attempts were going inwards rather than straight in Paris. The arm speed was fine, but the line could have made a difference of a couple of metres had it gone straighter," Neeraj said.

Neeraj is no stranger to groin issues. He was recommended surgery in 2023 before the World Championships in Eugene. In his pursuit of pushing his limits and nudging closer to greatness, he opted for a conservative approach rather than surgery.

But this season, his injury has restricted him to just five competitions, making going under the knife the only plausible permanent solution.

"I wanted to get that gold [at Worlds]; that was the only missing

Left is not right: Neeraj has admitted that a weak left leg results in his body collapsing to the left side, thereby affecting the trajectory or line of the throw. GETTY IMAGES